

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Clifford University Alumni Association Website

One Alumni. One Network. One Community.

Product: Clifford University Alumni Association Digital Platform

Document Type: Business Requirements / Product Requirements Document

Design Approach: Simple • Clean • Mobile-First • Fast • Secure • Accessible

Reference website supplied for inspiration: Covenant University — <https://www.covenantuniversity.edu.ng/>

Document purpose: Define the business, user, functional, design, security and administrative requirements for a modern alumni platform.

1. Executive Summary

The Clifford University Alumni Association Website is a centralized digital platform designed to connect alumni, maintain an accurate and continuously updated alumni database, communicate association activities, facilitate networking, manage membership, collect dues and donations, coordinate welfare activities, and provide opportunities for alumni to support one another.

The platform should replace fragmented communication and record-keeping methods—particularly scattered WhatsApp lists—with a structured digital system where alumni can maintain profiles, access verified member information, receive official announcements, register for events, make payments, access opportunities and interact with the wider alumni community.

2. Product Vision

To build a trusted digital home for Clifford University alumni where every alumnus can stay connected with the association, find and connect with fellow alumni, receive verified information, participate in events, access career and business opportunities, contribute to welfare and community development, maintain an up-to-date profile, support fellow alumni, and remain connected across different locations and generations.

3. Product Objectives

1. Create a centralized and reliable alumni database.
2. Provide an easy way for alumni to register and maintain their information.
3. Improve communication between EXCO and members.
4. Reduce dependence on WhatsApp for official records and transactions.
5. Create a trusted alumni networking environment.
6. Facilitate payment of dues, levies, donations and other contributions.
7. Create a structured welfare-management system.
8. Promote alumni businesses, careers and professional opportunities.
9. Preserve the history and memories of the alumni association.
10. Ensure continuity when new EXCO administrations take over.

4. Core Product Principles

Simple: Avoid unnecessary complexity; users should understand what to do without training.

Mobile-first: Design primarily for smartphones, while supporting tablets and desktop computers.

Fast: Prioritize performance over visual effects; avoid heavy animations, videos and unnecessary scripts.

Low-data friendly: Compress images and optimize pages for slower connections and lower-end devices.

Accessible: Use readable fonts, strong contrast, clear headings, large touch targets and logical navigation.

Secure and private: Members control what information they make visible, and sensitive information is protected.

5. Target Users

Alumni Members: Register, verify membership, create profiles, search alumni, attend events, pay dues, donate, access opportunities, participate in discussions and request welfare assistance.

EXCO / Executives: Manage members, announcements, events, welfare requests, payments, opportunities, gallery content and reports.

Welfare Team: Receive, review, assign and resolve confidential welfare cases.

School Management: Authorized representatives may publish official school information and participate in approved alumni initiatives.

System Administrator: Manages technical and platform-level administration.

6. Information Architecture / Website Structure

Primary navigation should include: Home, About, Alumni Network, Events, News & Announcements, Career & Business Hub, Welfare Center, Leadership, Gallery, Donate / Support, Contact, and Login / Join.

After login, members should have access to a personalized Member Dashboard.

7. Homepage Requirements

The homepage should immediately communicate who the platform is for and what users can do. Recommended sections: Header; Hero; Quick Actions; Upcoming Events; Latest Announcements; Featured Alumni; Leadership / EXCO; Welfare Highlight; Newsletter / Updates; Footer.

The hero should communicate the tagline **“One Alumni. One Network. One Community.”** with primary actions such as **Join the Alumni Network** and **Find an Alumni**.

Quick actions should include Find an Alumni, Upcoming Events, Pay Dues, Job Opportunities, Donate and Update Profile.

8. Alumni Membership System

Members should be able to register using email, phone number and, where supported, Google authentication. Registration can collect full name, email, phone number, graduation year, faculty, department/course, location, profession and profile photograph. Additional information can be collected after account creation.

9. Alumni Verification

A verification process should prevent unauthorized people from accessing members-only information. Possible methods include email verification, phone verification, graduation/set information and manual administrator verification.

Suggested statuses: Pending Verification, Verified, Active Member, Suspended and Inactive.

10. Member Profile

Every verified alumnus should have a personal profile containing profile photo, full name, graduation year, faculty, department/course, current location, profession, business, skills, short biography and optional social links. Members should control whether each field is public, visible to verified alumni or private.

A platform-based contact mechanism should allow members to communicate without exposing private email addresses or phone numbers.

11. Alumni Directory

The searchable directory should support filtering by name, graduation year/set, faculty, department/course, location, profession, business and skills. Directory cards should show photo, name, class/year, profession, location and a View Profile action.

12. Alumni Networking

The platform should support Find an Alumni, member messaging, connections/follows, recommendations, opportunity sharing, business referrals and professional networking. The goal is useful interaction without turning the site into an unnecessarily complex social network.

13. Events

Events should include AGM, reunions, webinars, career events, networking events, social events and fundraising activities. Each event should contain title, date, time, venue/online details, description, organizer, registration, attendance status and reminders. Administrators should be able to view registrations and attendee information.

14. News & Announcements

This should be the official communication center. Categories may include Association News, Official Announcements, School Management, Alumni Achievements, Weddings, Bereavements, Career Milestones and Important Notices. Authorized administrators should be able to create, schedule, edit, publish, unpublish and archive content.

15. Notification System

The platform should support website notifications and email notifications for major announcements, event reminders, payment confirmations, welfare updates and account notifications. Push notifications may be supported where practical. WhatsApp integration may complement—not replace—the website's official communication and record system.

16. Career & Business Hub

The hub should contain a Job Board, internships, freelance opportunities, referrals and an Alumni Business Directory. Members may voluntarily list business name, industry, location, services, website, social media and a controlled contact method.

Future capabilities can include "Hire an Alumni," "Support an Alumni Business" and mentorship matching.

17. Welfare Center

Members should be able to confidentially submit welfare assistance requests, emergency situations, bereavement notifications, illness notifications, financial assistance requests and reports concerning members in distress. Welfare information must be restricted to authorized personnel.

18. Welfare Admin Dashboard

Authorized welfare officers should see new, pending, active, resolved and urgent cases. Each case should have a case ID, member, category, date reported, assigned officer, status, internal notes and resolution. Ordinary alumni members must not be able to see another member's welfare case.

19. Dues, Levies & Payments

Members should be able to view current dues and levies, make payments, view payment history, see outstanding balances and download receipts. Payment categories may include membership dues, annual dues, special levies, event contributions, welfare contributions, fundraising and other approved payments.

20. Donate / Support

The platform should allow alumni to contribute to welfare funds, scholarships, university projects, emergency assistance, association programmes, partnerships and sponsorship. Every transaction should produce a transaction ID, date, amount, purpose, payment status and receipt.

21. Member Dashboard

After login, members should see a personalized dashboard such as "Welcome, [Name]" with membership status, outstanding dues, upcoming events and notifications. Quick actions should include My Profile, Alumni Directory, Events,

Jobs, Messages, Welfare, Payments, Donations and Notifications.

22. Profile Completion

The dashboard should encourage members to keep their information current. A profile-completion indicator such as “Your profile is 80% complete” can encourage users to provide missing information.

23. Discussion / Community

A moderated discussion area may contain General Discussion, Career, Business, Set/Year Groups, Events, Alumni Support and Suggestions. Members may create posts, comment, react and report inappropriate content. Administrators need moderation tools.

24. Chat

A basic private messaging system can be included in the initial or subsequent release. Future functionality may include group conversations, set-based groups, professional groups and event groups.

25. Gallery

The gallery should preserve alumni memories through albums for Reunions, AGM, Alumni Events, University Memories and Historical Archive. Images should be optimized for performance.

26. Alumni History & Archive

The About section should preserve the association's history, Vision & Mission, Objectives, Constitution, Code of Conduct and Organizational Structure.

27. Leadership

Dedicated profiles should be available for current executives, including photograph, name, position, biography and professional background. The platform must allow leadership information to be updated when a new EXCO takes office.

28. Admin Dashboard

The admin dashboard should provide total members, verified/active members, pending verification, alumni by graduation year/location/profession, welfare cases, pending requests, upcoming events, donations and payment statistics.

29. Member Management

Administrators should be able to search members, verify members, edit records, suspend or activate accounts, view membership history and export permitted reports.

30. Administrative Roles & Permissions

Suggested roles are Super Administrator, EXCO Administrator, Finance Administrator, Welfare Administrator, Content Administrator and Moderator. Role-based permissions prevent every administrator from accessing every category of information.

31. Continuity & Handover

The platform must not depend on one individual. New administrations should inherit the member database, financial records, events, announcements, permitted welfare records, content, administrative accounts, reports and historical records. A formal EXCO handover process should be supported.

32. Chatbot

A chatbot may be introduced to answer common questions, explain registration and membership, direct users to payment/event pages and provide basic platform assistance. It should be monitored by authorized administrators and should not be allowed to delay the core website launch.

33. Search

Global search should allow users to find alumni, events, announcements, jobs, businesses, pages and FAQs. Mobile search should be particularly easy to access.

34. FAQ & Contact

FAQ topics may include registration, verification, profile updates, dues, contacting alumni, welfare requests, job posts and business listings. Contact should provide official email/phone information, contact form, social media and association office information.

35. Privacy Requirements

Members should control visibility of personal information. A suggested default is that name, graduation year, faculty/department, profession and location are visible to verified alumni, while phone and personal email remain private unless the member chooses otherwise.

36. Security Requirements

The platform should implement secure authentication, password protection, email/phone verification, role-based access control, secure payment processing, data encryption, regular backups, audit logs, session management, account recovery, spam protection and abuse reporting. Financial and welfare data require additional protection.

37. Performance Requirements

The website should feel fast on slower connections. Requirements include compressed images, lazy loading, optimized code, minimal animations, efficient database queries, caching, lightweight pages, responsive design and minimal third-party scripts. Functionality should take priority over visual effects.

38. Accessibility

Use high color contrast, readable typography, large tap targets, proper heading hierarchy, keyboard navigation, alternative text for images, visible focus states and clear accessible forms.

39. Analytics & Reporting

Administrators should be able to understand usage through metrics such as registered/verified alumni, active users, profile completion, directory searches, event registrations, payment activity, donation activity, job posts, business listings, welfare requests and announcement engagement.

40. Feedback System

Provide a simple Give Feedback function for suggestions, complaints, feature requests, website issues and general feedback. Administrators should be able to review and categorize submissions.

41. Content Moderation

Members should be able to report spam, abuse, false information, inappropriate content and suspicious accounts. Administrators can review, remove, warn, suspend or ban accounts according to association policy.

42. Recommended MVP

Phase 1 should focus on Homepage, Membership Registration, Alumni Verification, Member Profiles, Alumni Directory, Events, News & Announcements, Dues/Payments, Donations, Member Dashboard, Admin Dashboard, Leadership, Gallery, Basic Notifications, Privacy and Security.

43. Phase 2

Introduce Career & Business Hub, Job Board, Business Directory, member messaging, discussion forum, Welfare Center, Mentorship, Alumni Achievements, advanced analytics and WhatsApp integration.

44. Phase 3

Consider dedicated alumni webmail, AI chatbot, advanced alumni matching, automated event reminders, advanced reporting, alumni mobile application, digital membership card, advanced fundraising campaigns and set/community pages.

45. Unique Alumni Webmail

A dedicated alumni email identity may be valuable in the future because it protects personal email addresses and creates an official alumni identity. However, running a real email service introduces hosting, security, storage, spam, account recovery, administration and cost requirements, so it should not delay the initial website launch.

46. Homepage Content Priority

Recommended hierarchy: Hero → Find an Alumni / Join Network → Upcoming Events → Important Announcements → Featured Alumni → EXCO → Welfare / Community → Career & Business Opportunities → Gallery → Newsletter → Footer.

47. Design Direction

Visual style: Simple, Premium, Institutional and Modern. Use official university/alumni brand colors with a restrained palette, readable typography such as Inter, Manrope, DM Sans or Plus Jakarta Sans, moderate spacing, subtle borders and clear calls to action. Avoid excessive glassmorphism, gradients and animation.

48. Mobile Experience

Mobile should be treated as the primary interface. Navigation should remain simple and the most important actions should be one or two taps away. Recommended prominent actions include JOIN NETWORK, FIND ALUMNI, PAY DUES, REGISTER FOR EVENT and REQUEST WELFARE.

49. Key User Journeys

New Alumni: Homepage → Join Network → Register → Verify → Complete Profile → Approval → Dashboard.

Find Alumni: Homepage → Find Alumni → Search → Filter → Profile → Contact.

Pay Dues: Login → Dashboard → Payments → View Dues → Pay → Confirmation → Receipt.

Event: Homepage → Event → Details → Register → Confirmation → Reminder.

Welfare: Login → Welfare Center → Submit Request → Welfare Team Review → Resolution.

Job: Login → Career Hub → Job Board → Search → View Job → Apply/Contact.

50. Core Data Entities

Likely entities include User, Alumni Profile, Membership, Graduation Set, Faculty, Department, Location, Profession, Event, Event Registration, Announcement, Job, Business, Welfare Case, Payment, Donation, Receipt, Notification, Message, Discussion, Gallery, Gallery Album, Executive, Feedback and Audit Log.

51. Key Performance Indicators

Membership: registered alumni, verified alumni and profile completion.

Engagement: monthly active members, directory searches, event registrations and discussion participation.

Financial: online dues collection, donation volume and payment completion rate.

Networking: alumni connections, job posts, business listings and mentorship participation.

Communication: announcement views and notification engagement.

Welfare: welfare requests processed, response time and cases resolved.

52. Business Value

The platform provides a centralized database, better communication, financial transparency, stronger alumni networking, better welfare coordination, institutional continuity and data-informed decision-making.

53. Risks & Mitigation

Low adoption: Keep registration and usage simple.

Outdated profiles: Use profile reminders and periodic verification.

Privacy concerns: Provide strong privacy controls.

Fake accounts: Use membership verification.

Poor internet: Use lightweight pages and optimized images.

Admin turnover: Use role-based accounts and structured handover.

Data loss: Use automated backups.

Spam/abuse: Provide moderation and reporting.

Payment issues: Use reliable payment processing and transaction records.

Developer dependency: Provide a capable administrative dashboard and documentation.

54. Product Success Definition

The platform should answer five questions: Can an alumnus easily find another alumnus? Can an alumnus easily know what is happening? Can an alumnus easily contribute financially? Can an alumnus easily get opportunities or support? Can the association manage its members and activities without depending on one person? The answer should be yes to all five.

55. Final Product Positioning

The website should not simply be an online brochure. It should become the association's digital operating platform and community hub—bringing together identity, connection, communication, opportunity, welfare, contribution, memory and governance.

Guiding philosophy: “Simple enough for everyone. Useful enough to visit regularly. Secure enough to trust. Structured enough to serve the association for years.”